iv Fibre Restricted Diet

Fibre restricted diet have reduced fibre content and are soft in consistency. It serves as a transition to a normal diet in fevers, and in gastrointestinal disturbances.

v. Regular Diet

The regular diet is the most frequently used in hospitals. It should meet the RDA and include all food groups (refer to XI Home Science Text book).

1.2 Diet in Fever

Fever may be defined as an elevation of body temperature above normal (98.4°F). It may occur in response to infection and inflammation.

Causes of Fever

Endogenous factors: Antigen-antibody reaction.

Exogenous factors: Infection due to Bacteria or Fungi.

Classification of Fever

- **Short duration:** as in acute fevers of colds, pneumonia, influenza, measles, chickenpox, scarlet and typhoid fevers. All these diseases manifest fever as the first symptom.
- **Long duration:** as in chronic fevers or infections which may continue for months and stretch to years. Tuberculosis is an outstanding example.
- **Intermittent:** Fever in which increased body temperature last for few hours alternate with periods in which the temperature is normal. e.g., Malaria.

Metabolic Changes in Fever

1. The metabolic rate is increased. The increase in metabolic rate is proportionate to body temperature and the duration of fever. An increase of 7 percent in the metabolic rate for each degree rise in Fahrenheit (13 percent for every degree Celsius rise in body temperature).
2. Glycogen stores are decreased.
3. Increased catabolism of proteins.
4. Nitrogen waste is increased and it exerts an additional burden on the kidneys.
5. Water metabolism is also affected. Excessive perspiration and excretion of body waste increases the loss of body water.
6. Increased excretion of electrolytes like sodium and potassium.

1.2.1 Typhoid

Typhoid is an infectious disease with an acute fever of short duration. *Salmonella typhi* causes typhoid. The duration may be as short as three days or as long as three weeks.

Causes of Typhoid

Contaminated drinking water, milk and food by intestinal contents of a patient or handling of food by carriers or by flies, are the source of infection.

Symptoms of Typhoid

The disease is characterized by a continued, high inflammation of the intestine, formation of intestinal ulcers, haemorrhage and enlargement of spleen. The patient suffers from:

- Diarrhoea or constipation
- Severe stomach ache.
- Headache and anorexia.

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